



Individual Instructor Report Fall 2025 Version B for ECO 329 - ECONOMIC STATISTICS (36110) (Ziheng Yu)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Fall 2025**

Courses Audience: **65**

Responses Received: **26**

Response Ratio: **40.0 %**

Subject Details

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Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness, multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor. For additional details, including the scales and how the Mean scores are calculated, please review the Report Guide at the end of this document or, [UT Austin's Viewing Course Evaluation Results webpage](#).

Creation Date: **Monday, January 26, 2026**

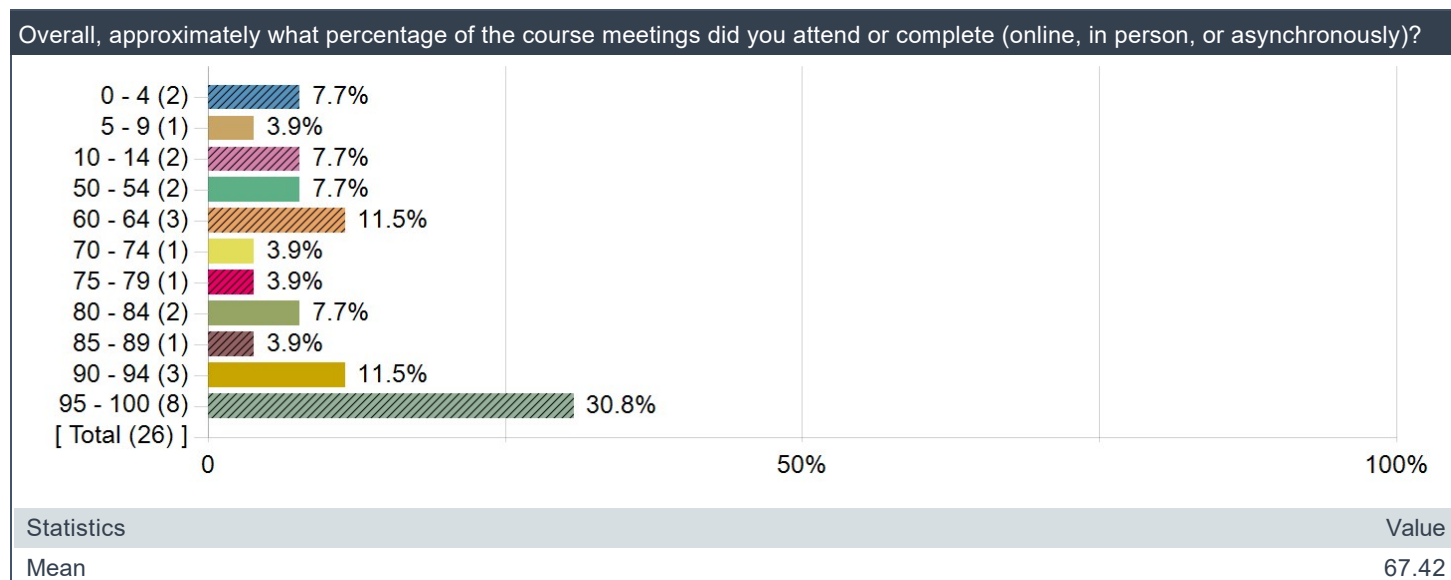
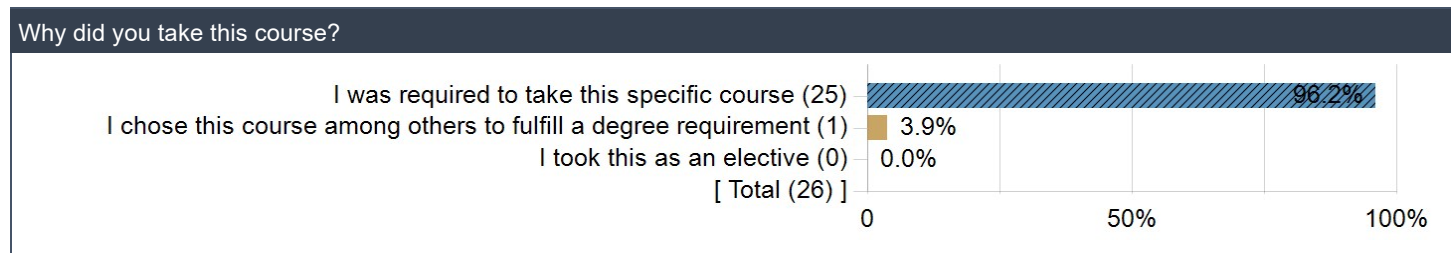
Core Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.	3.8%	15.4%	15.4%	34.6%	30.8%	26	2.27
The course was well organized.	0.0%	11.5%	19.2%	30.8%	38.5%	26	2.04
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	0.0%	15.4%	15.4%	26.9%	42.3%	26	2.04
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	0.0%	26.9%	38.5%	15.4%	19.2%	26	2.73
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	0.0%	3.8%	7.7%	38.5%	50.0%	26	1.65
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	0.0%	3.8%	23.1%	19.2%	53.8%	26	1.77
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	0.0%	19.2%	34.6%	19.2%	26.9%	26	2.46

Overall Questions

	Excellent	Very Good	Satisfactory	Unsatisfactory	Very Unsatisfactory	Responded	Mean
Overall, this instructor was	0.0%	0.0%	11.5%	50.0%	38.5%	26	1.73
Overall, this course was	0.0%	0.0%	15.4%	34.6%	50.0%	26	1.65

Other Course Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comment
Doing examples in class and posting the work done in class
if anything maybe problems sets
The practice problems were essential, and the TA's walkthroughs of the more difficult problems were very helpful.
There wasn't really anything, this course was extremely hard because of the unorganizing notes and the lack of efficient teaching. At the beginning of the course, no practice problems were given to help understand the material, and there was overall such a huge confusion about the structure of the class, the material, and what we needed to do to succeed.
Professor Yu made an effort to adjust the class when students complained and tried different teaching methods.
I thought once Ziheng changed his methods for the second half, and gave us practice problems after each lecture note, it was most effective help in my learning and telling us exactly what we need to know for the exams.
Aside from the small detail that absolutely nothing in this class helped me learn anything at all, everything was perfect. Truly. But for clarity, here's a short list of the minor inconveniences we all experienced: • The instructor's explanations were so unclear and misleading that even the TAs and Sanger Learning Center tutors couldn't decipher them — which I'm sure was just part of the "challenge." • Every time I asked for help, I was told to "study" — an incredibly insightful piece of advice that solved absolutely none of the confusion he created. • The TAs frequently admitted they were lost too, which really boosted my confidence in the course structure. • The class had to be revised because the instructor didn't know the actual prerequisites... despite writing them on the syllabus himself. A fun plot twist for us all. • The syllabus seemed copied and pasted together, which matched perfectly with the teaching style: inconsistent, unprepared, and disconnected from what we were supposed to be learning. • After doing some digging, it turns out the instructor has taken none of the foundational courses required to teach this material — which, honestly, explains everything. • He also openly said he didn't want to teach this course, and every lecture definitely reflected that sentiment.
So yes — aside from all of that, the class was mediocre on a good day. Saying anything positive would be pure fiction. I would absolutely never take a class taught like this again, and I sincerely hope future students are spared this experience.
This was genuinely the absolute worst course that I have taken at UT. This professor was extremely disorganized, not prepared, and unclear in his expectations in the course especially pertaining to the tests.
Notes posted online, exams with well-written answers to look back on, reviews
He was open to changing his teaching style after criticism.
After the first exam and we all expressed our concern for the material and difficulty, he took our concerns into consideration and matched the class difficulty to that of the other section. He fixed the problem sets to be more relevant to what we're learning and didn't get as off track as he used to. The lecture notes he posted on canvas were particularly helpful and his timeliness in email responses were good.
Going over the Problem sets before a test
Sometimes the homeworks but other than that not really anything much.
For the first half of the semester, I did not attend a single class because Ziheng was such a bad teacher that it hurt my understanding by showing up to class. I did not attend a single class before the first midterm and taught myself all of the content and scored one of the highest grades in the class, which was a 40%. As a transfer student to UT Austin, this was an extremely disappointing first impression of the Economics department. I was truly disappointed with the quality of education. After the first midterm, Ziheng took massive strides to become a more efficient teacher, and it was better, but still extremely underwhelming.
n/a
Doing sample problems was the most effective in helping me understand the lecture content, along with the problem sets.
office hour
Worse Professor ever. Should never be allowed to teach ever again.

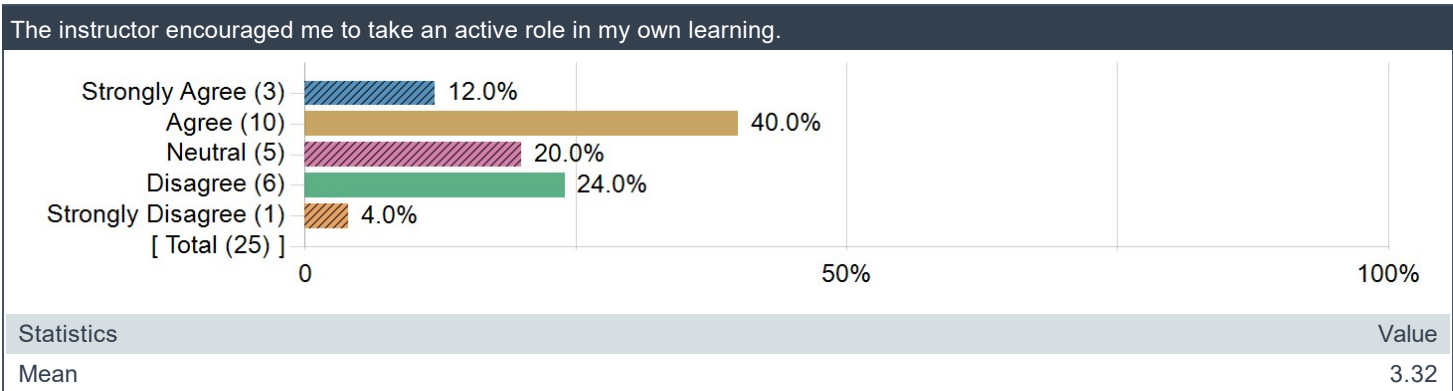
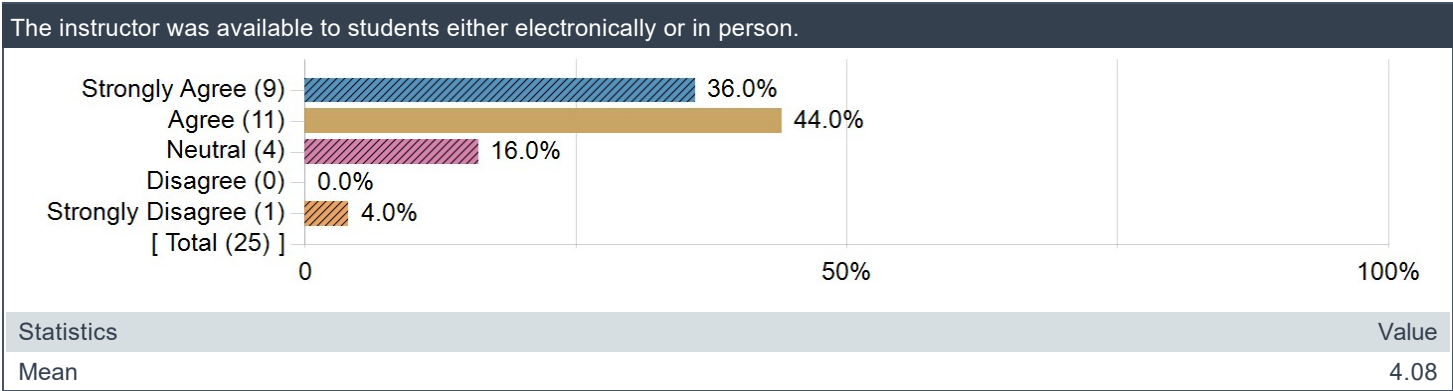
Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comment
Taking what we learn in class and applying it to the homework sets because most times the examples in class aren't as hard as

Comment
the homework problems so I end up learning the information on my own, advice would be to fully understand information and how to use it in different ways for the tests
everything including test, no preparation or organization, new teacher
Given it was the instructors first time teaching this course in person I understand the difficulties. With that being said, I found most of the course work to be very different and much harder compared to other teachers.
I couldn't really keep up with the instructor, he would often go on tangents and make very confusing notes
the professors teaching style was horrible and the organization was incredibly confusing.
The class was disorganized and often difficult to follow. The instructor wrote math notes on the same pages as his printed notes and frequently scratched out work while moving forward, making the notes hard to read. He could improve both his presentation skills and note-taking methods. Additionally, he seemed unfamiliar with the prerequisites for the class and expressed disagreement with the course design, which is concerning, as it is the instructor's responsibility to teach the course as designed.
I thought the first half was the most challenging because he used variables instead of numbers for every probability problem which made the course really difficult. In the future, he should lower the difficulty and use numbers for everything as he did in the second half.
The most challenging part of this course was, without question, the professor. He was stubborn, vastly inexperienced, and completely unwilling to accommodate any student needs until it was far too late—well after the majority of us were already struggling or failing. He consistently left us in the dark and watched the class crumble, all while repeatedly misleading us about the structure of the midterms, how we were being graded, and what the expectations even were.
To this day, we still have no clarity on Canvas because he does not seem to know how to properly upload or calculate grades. This, once again, reflects his overwhelming lack of experience and preparation as an instructor. The course was challenging solely because of Ziheng Yu, not because of the content itself.
If I had to suggest one thing that could help future students meet the challenges of this course, it would be extremely simple: do not take this instructor. He is the entire reason this class has been so insufferable.
I would genuinely rather sweep the entire ocean on the hottest day in Florida than sit through this class again. It would be easier—and more time-efficient—for me to figure out how many licks it takes to get to the center of a Tootsie Pop than to complete a single one of his problem sets.
This professor makes extremely confusing and wordy practice problems and then the tests are almost exactly the same except extremely long given the time given and almost impossible to complete in the given time. I would advise students to AVOID THIS INSTRUCTOR AT ALL COSTS.
Lectures didn't feel useful, add more practice in between definitions to be understand them
Professor Yu was, without a doubt, the worst instructor I has ever had.
Truly, this is not his fault. It is the fault of UT's Department of Economics. Yu was clearly not prepared and poorly instructed on the structure of the course, the syllabus, and teaching an economics course at UT in general. Examples of this were clear when: nobody could understand anything about what would be tested until the week of the test; the average of the first miderm was a 20%, such that contained graduate-level questions because they would be "good practice for grad school"; when he was absolutely clueless of the fact that calculus II was not a pre-req for this course, only realizing this when one student who was a MATH MAJOR brought it up because the rest of us were too lost in the lecture to even notice we were looking at double integrals; when he spent much of the first weeks of the class explaining complex proofs of probability theory that were not at all relevant to the exam, making everyone confused and at the point of dropping the course; believing everything he was doing before the first exam was okay because the last time he taught this course was online, where he used calc II still saw better grades (It baffles me that UT and the department did not catch on to the fact that an instructor was testing material that is not in the pre reqs of a course just because nobody complained because these students were obviously using AI during tests); the complete disconnection to anything economics related in the course (he even said himself that the course should be called probability theory and not economic statistics because I have seen nothing econ related); and when it was obvious that this section was way more challenging than the other Econ Stats class, which at least related the content to our major, and, again, left us understanding virtually nothing.
I also hate to mention this, because, as an international student myself, I relate to the struggle of being in the US with English as my non-native language, but—and I say this with nothing but good intent—I could not understand half of what Yu said in his lectures, and in a technical course like Econ Stats, it really took me out of it and resulted in me and most of my peers learning NOTHING.
I moved countries to come to UT and learn, and it saddens me to say that I have retained nothing from this course. Chances are I'll still pass because I've studied extensively on my own and in study groups, but this is ridiculous. I have gone in to way too much college debt to go into a class and understand nothing. I am not a bad student and have done well in my math coursework so far, so this is not my fault. The department's lack of care has resulted in me not having the necessary tools to succeed in my following economics coursework. This really saddens me because I am passionate about Economics and actually love my major, but this is

Comment
ridiculous.
This class unfortunately was a lot more challenging than it should have been, but it got better throughout the semester. The first exam's difficulty seemed to be like that of a grad class as the class average was a 20 and the highest grade was a 55. I believe it was a communication error because he ended up changing the structure and difficulty of the class after that exam. His teaching style was still a little all over the place and hard to understand, but overall it did improve from the beginning. As it was hard to understand the content from his lectures, I had to do most of my learning from the textbook and reading his written notes. One thing that could be done to help future students could be to just start at the regular difficulty from the beginning and to not spend as much time going over content that will not be tested.
He just writes over his notes with no clear direction or plan in place. Very unorganized and did not set a clear expectation of what we needed to know. Would show us proofs of things for most of the class even though we do not need to show proofs on the test. Not a good communicator as far what he is trying to teach and when we ask if he could show us more examples in class of what the test were like, our requests were denied. One thing that could be done to help future students is for the professor having a agenda of what is going to be covered for each class.
The first exam was terribly difficult with the average mean and median being around a 20. I believe the reason I found it so challenging was because what the professor told us to go over was completly different than what the exam contained and he also didn't really give much material to go over and for the students to have an idea with what could be expected. So something that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively is provide more content towards the exam and be more explicit and lenient with the material.
His teaching abilities were not adequate for this course. I couldn't understand what he was trying to say, and he didn't know how to explain topics in a way that we, his students, would understand.
See above. Lots of challenges involving Ziheng's teaching styles.
0 practice exams, 0 practice problems, didn't release grades until before the final exam
Sometimes I get lost during the lecture, whether it is due to complex wording or extra information. Maybe in the future, do the basic concepts first with the problems, and if there's time at the end of class, go into proofs and explanations.
everything
Everything

College, School, or Unit Questions



Report Guide

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.